

Usability test script - Web sites

Reprinted from *Rocket Surgery Made Easy*

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THE INSTRUCTIONS

Web browser should be open to Google or some other “neutral” page

Hi, ____ My name is Rinzin and I’m going to be walking you through this session today.

Before we begin, I have some information for you, and I’m going to read it to make sure that I cover everything.

You probably already have a good idea of why we asked you here but let me go over it again briefly. We’re asking people to try using a Web site that we’re working on so we can see whether it works as intended. The session should take about an hour.

The first thing I want to make clear right away is that we’re testing the *site*, not you. You can’t do anything wrong here. In fact, this is probably the one place today where you don’t have to worry about making mistakes.

As you use the site, I’m going to ask you as much as possible to try to think out loud: to say what you’re looking at, what you’re trying to do, and what you’re thinking. This will be a big help to us.

Also, please don't worry that you're going to hurt our feelings. We're doing this to improve the site, so we need to hear your honest reactions.

If you have any questions as we go along, just ask them. I may not be able to answer them right away, since we're interested in how people do when they don't have someone sitting next to them to help. But if you still have any questions when we're done I'll try to answer them then. And if you need to take a break at any point, just let me know.

You may have noticed the microphone. With your permission, we're going to record what happens on the screen and our conversation. The recording will only be used to help us figure out how to improve the site, and it won't be seen by anyone except the people working on this project. And it helps me, because I don't have to take as many notes.

Also, there are a few people from the Web design team observing this session in another room. (They can't see us, just the screen.)

If you would, I'm going to ask you to sign a simple permission form for us. It just says that we have your permission to record you, and that the recording will only be seen by the people working on the project.

Give them a recording permission form and a pen

While they sign it, START the SCREEN RECORDER

Do you have any questions so far?

THE QUESTIONS (Pre-Survey)

OK. Before we look at the site, I'd like to ask you just a few quick questions.

First, what's your occupation? What do you do all day?

Roughly how many hours a week altogether would you say you spend using the Internet, including Web browsing and email, at work and at home?

Have you ever used any job portals websites to apply job — part-time, full-time, or survival work?

Do you have any favorite job search website and why?

What features do you like most from your favorite job search website?

What features other features do you think it's important or helpful but not included in your favorite site?

~~What kinds of sites (work and personal) are you looking at when you browse the Web?~~

~~Do you have any favorite Web sites?~~

THE HOME PAGE TOUR

OK, great. We're done with the questions, and we can start looking at things.

Click on the bookmark for the site's Home page.

First, I'm going to ask you to look at this page and tell me what you make of it: what strikes you about it, whose site you think it is, what you can do here, and what it's for. Just look around and do a little narrative.

You can scroll if you want to, but don't click on anything yet.

Allow this to continue for three or four minutes, at most.

THE TASKS

Thanks. Now I'm going to ask you to try doing some specific tasks. I'm going to read each one out loud and give you a printed copy.

I'm also going to ask you to do these tasks without using Search. We'll learn a lot more about how well the site works that way.

And again, as much as possible, it will help us if you can try to think out loud as you go along.

Task 1: Search

- You're looking for a part-time Sales Associate job in Etobicoke.
- Search for that job role in that location and tell me how many results appear.

Task 2 : Filter Jobs

- Filter the results by location, role, and company to find a Sales Associate position in Toronto.
- How many results do you see after filtering?

Task 3: Save a Job for Later

- Find a Sales Associate job listing in Toronto and save it to your favorites for later reference. Once you've saved it, return to the home page and find that saved posting.
- Please check and tell me the date when that job was posted on the portal.

Task 4: Retrieve Saved Job Information

- Starting from the home page, locate your saved or favorited job postings.
- Can you find the job you saved in the previous task? Please confirm you can see it on the home page and retrieve the posting date for that saved job.

Hand the participant the first scenario, and read it aloud.

Allow the user to proceed until you don't feel like it's producing any value or the user becomes very frustrated.

Repeat for each task or until time runs out.

PROBING

Thanks, that was very helpful.

If you'll excuse me for a minute, I'm just going to see if the people on the team have any follow-up questions they'd like me to ask you.

Call the observation room to see if the observers have any questions.

- **Comparison questions**

Ask the observers' questions, then probe anything you want to follow up on.

- **Comparison questions**

WRAPPING UP

Do you have any questions for me, now that we're done?

Give them their incentive, or remind them it will be sent to them.

Stop the screen recorder and save the file.

Thank them and escort them out.